



Brian Shimkus

SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING · AI INTEGRATION

Chicago, IL

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Front-end developer moving into solutions engineering. Twelve years delivering customer-facing solutions inside regulated financial organizations taught me to run stakeholder discovery, demo to technical and executive audiences, and integrate enterprise APIs under compliance and security constraints. Through Insolla, my self-directed practice, I build production-grade AI systems end to end with the pre-sales artifacts that accompany them: RAG over live CRM data, identity policy automation, document workflows.

SKILLS

PRE-SALES	Technical Discovery, Tailored Demos, Proof of Concept (POC), Proof of Value (POV), Solution Design, Objection Handling, Security Reviews, Executive Presentations, Technical Handoff
AI AND LLM	OpenAI API, LangChain, Pinecone, RAG Architecture, Embeddings, Vector Databases, Structured Outputs, Source Grounding, Evaluation and Guardrails, Prompt Engineering, Python
INTEGRATION	REST APIs, JSON, FastAPI, Salesforce API (OAuth 2.0 JWT), DocuSign API, Webhooks, Node.js, SQL, MySQL, AWS, Git
AUTOMATION	Make.com, n8n, Airtable, Hunter.io, Brevo
FRONT-END	React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Jest, Playwright, Vercel

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Applied AI Engineering**
Insolla (Self-Directed AI Practice)

Dec 2025 – Present

 - Build AI systems end to end across CRM intelligence, identity governance, and document workflows, integrating live third-party platforms through REST APIs, webhooks, and iPaaS tooling.
 - Author the full pre-sales artifact set for each system: discovery guide, stakeholder map, technical walkthrough, security brief, and POV plan.
 - Cut a small business's social media workflow from 8 hours per week to 10 minutes with an automated content pipeline, scoped and delivered directly with the owner.
 - Design for security review: scoped access, documented data handling and retention, and OAuth 2.0 JWT server-to-server auth against a live Salesforce org.
 - Ship every system with source grounding, structured outputs, and human-review paths; can defend each against the standard objections on hallucination risk and data security.
- Lead Front-End Developer**
TerraFort (Freelance)

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

 - Led design and development of a web and mobile platform at an early-stage startup, executing product initiatives from concept to delivery.
 - Owned vendor-facing technical evaluations, scoping and integrating third-party and AI tooling into the product; led collaboration across UX, product, and backend teams.
- Senior Front-End Developer**
OCC (Contract)

Jul 2024 – Jun 2025

 - Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility, covering goal setting, live progress demos, and open-question resolution across multiple workstreams.
 - Independently delivered React and TypeScript solutions from Figma through production across test, QA, and prod environments; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock front-end work from backend dependencies.

- Led the program that digitalized broker and trader onboarding at a global financial services firm, replacing a compliance-heavy, paper-based workflow with a fully digital process end to end and measurably shortening the onboarding cycle.
- Won adoption from the trading and operations teams whose daily work changed, partnering with compliance and operations stakeholders to scope each rollout.
- Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across all products.
- Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions in an agile environment; designed and ran the team's internship program.

SELECTED PROJECTS AND CASE STUDIES

Salesforce Intelligence (Flagship Demo Asset)

Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) assistant answering natural-language questions over live Salesforce CRM records. Syncs Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities, embeds them into a Pinecone vector index, and returns answers cited back to the source records, so every claim is traceable to a row a rep can open. Built with Python, LangChain, and OpenAI; secured with OAuth 2.0 JWT server-to-server auth against a live org, scoped field access, and no credentials in the client.

Est. impact: Turns a multi-record manual lookup across Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities into one sourced answer in seconds.

[brianshimkus.com/case-studies/salesforce-intelligence](#) | [rag.insolla.ai](#) | [github.com/brianshimkus/Insolla-Salesforce-RAG](#)

Employee Access Lifecycle Assistant

Deterministic identity policy engine that evaluates employee role changes against access policy, flags separation-of-duties conflicts, and routes risky combinations to human security review before anything is granted. Decisions are rule-based rather than model-generated; the LLM only explains them in plain language. Provisions through connectors with an append-only audit trail.

Est. impact: Modeled to cut ~52 hours/month of manual IT provisioning effort to policy-driven, auditable decisions.

[brianshimkus.com/case-studies/employee-access-lifecycle](#) | [github.com/brianshimkus/Employee-Access-Lifecycle-Assistant](#)

POD Recovery Assistant

SOP-grounded workflow that recovers missing proof-of-delivery documents for a freight brokerage. Identifies open exceptions, drafts carrier outreach grounded in the operator's own SOP rather than free generation, and holds every message at a human approval gate before it sends, with a full audit trail on each action.

Est. impact: Modeled to cut ~240 hours/month of manual follow-up to a handful of human-reviewed exceptions.

[brianshimkus.com/case-studies/pod-recovery-assistant](#) | [github.com/brianshimkus/Freight-POD-Recovery](#)

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Developer / Walker & Dunlop (Contract) — Built Vue.js platform components with Storybook; connected front-end to APIs.	Mar 2020 – Oct 2020
Senior Front-End Developer / ICF — Led front-end lifecycle; standardized web accessibility across projects.	Jan 2019 – Mar 2020
Front-End Developer / TransUnion — Built a Contentful-based CMS for marketing content owners; deployed to AWS.	Jan 2018 – Jan 2019
UX Architect and Front-End Developer / R1 RCM — Partnered with directors to identify product gaps; built working AngularJS prototypes to validate solutions.	Apr 2016 – Jan 2018
Front-End Developer / TimeZoneOne (Contract) — Custom WordPress themes and cross-browser development; clients included Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.	Aug 2015 – Apr 2016
Junior Front-End Developer / Kohactive — Built responsive client sites (Ruby on Rails, SASS); led client meetings with Aon, Manchester United, and The Vitality Group.	Aug 2013 – Aug 2015

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design / Art Institute of Chicago — 3.9 GPA, Dean's List	2013
Instructional Design and Technology / Western Illinois University	2008 – 2010